

eat4me

Privacy Policy

How We Collect, Use, and Protect Your Personal Information

Effective Date: Upon Account Registration or First Platform Access

Jurisdiction: Republic of Ghana

Governing Law: Ghana Data Protection Act, 2012 (Act 843)

About This Policy

eat4me is a technology marketplace platform that connects independent home cooks and chefs with customers. To make that connection work — and to keep it safe, reliable, and personal — we collect certain information about you.

This Privacy Policy explains exactly what information we collect, why we collect it, how we use it, who we share it with, how long we keep it, and what rights you have over it.

We are committed to handling your personal information responsibly and in compliance with Ghana's Data Protection Act, 2012 (Act 843) and all applicable data protection laws.

By using the eat4me platform — whether as a customer, chef, home cook, vendor, delivery rider, or visitor — you acknowledge that you have read and understood this Privacy Policy.

1. Who We Are

eat4me operates a technology marketplace platform connecting independent home cooks, chefs, and food vendors with customers seeking authentic home-cooked meals. eat4me is the data controller responsible for your personal information collected through our mobile application, website, and related services.

For the purposes of Ghana's Data Protection Act, 2012 (Act 843), eat4me is a registered data controller. If you have questions about how we handle your personal information, please contact our Data Protection Officer using the contact details in Section 15 of this Policy.

2. Information We Collect

We collect different types of information depending on how you interact with the eat4me platform. We collect only what is necessary to provide, improve, and protect our services.

2.1 Personal Identification Information

When you register an account or use our services, we may collect:

- Full name
- Email address
- Phone number
- Delivery address and location details
- Date of birth (where required for age verification)
- Government-issued identification (for chef and vendor verification only)

2.2 Account and Profile Information

- Account credentials and login details
- Dietary preferences, food allergies, and nutritional requirements
- Profile photos, videos, and personal introductions (for chefs and vendors)
- User-generated content including reviews, ratings, and feedback
- Saved addresses and order preferences

2.3 Payment and Financial Information

To process payments and settlements, we collect:

- Mobile money account details
- Bank account or card information (processed through secure third-party payment processors)
- Transaction history, refund records, and payment confirmations

Important: eat4me does not store complete card or bank account details on its own servers. All payment data is processed through certified, secure third-party payment processors. eat4me retains only transaction references and confirmation records necessary for order management and dispute resolution.

2.4 Transactional Data

- Orders placed and meals purchased
- Order history, cancellations, and modifications
- Refunds, promotions, credits, and rewards usage
- Chef order acceptance and fulfilment records
- Delivery confirmation and handover records

2.5 Device and Technical Information

When you access our platform, we automatically collect certain technical information:

- IP address and approximate geographic location
- Device type, model, and operating system
- Browser type and version
- App version and session data
- Platform usage analytics and interaction patterns
- Crash reports and error logs

2.6 Location Data

With your permission, we collect precise location data to:

- Match you with nearby chefs and cooks
- Facilitate accurate delivery to your location
- Provide estimated delivery times

You may disable location access at any time through your device settings. Disabling location may limit certain platform features. We do not collect location data when the app is not in use unless you have explicitly granted background location permission.

2.7 Communications Data

- Messages exchanged with chefs, vendors, or eat4me support through the platform

- Customer support inquiries and complaint records
- Feedback and survey responses
- Marketing communication preferences and opt-out records

2.8 Cookies and Tracking Technologies

We use cookies, pixels, and similar tracking technologies to improve user experience, analyze platform usage, and deliver relevant content. For full details, see Section 7 of this Policy.

2.9 Information from Third Parties

We may receive information about you from:

- Payment processors and financial institutions for payment verification
- Social media platforms if you choose to log in or connect your account
- Marketing and analytics partners to improve platform performance • Government or regulatory authorities where required by law

3. Legal Basis for Processing Your Information

Under Ghana's Data Protection Act, 2012 (Act 843), we are required to have a lawful basis for collecting and processing your personal information. We process your data on the following grounds:

- **Contract Performance:** Processing is necessary to fulfill the services you have requested, including order processing, delivery coordination, and payment settlement.
- **Legal Obligation:** Processing is required to comply with applicable laws, regulations, and government or regulatory requests.
- **Legitimate Interests:** Processing is necessary for our legitimate business interests, including platform security, fraud prevention, and service improvement, provided such interests are not overridden by your rights.
- **Consent:** Where we process your data based on consent — such as for marketing communications or optional location tracking — you may withdraw consent at any time without affecting the lawfulness of prior processing.

4. How We Use Your Information

We use the information we collect for the following purposes:

4.1 Providing and Operating the Platform

- Processing and fulfilling food orders
- Coordinating delivery logistics with independent riders
- Facilitating payment processing and settlements
- Managing accounts, profiles, and platform access
- Sending order confirmations, receipts, and status updates

4.2 Customer Support and Communication

- Responding to inquiries, complaints, and support requests
- Resolving disputes between customers, chefs, and riders
- Communicating important platform updates and policy changes
- Sending transactional notifications related to orders

4.3 Safety, Security, and Fraud Prevention

- Detecting, investigating, and preventing fraudulent transactions
- Monitoring platform activity for security threats and policy violations
- Verifying the identity and eligibility of chefs and vendors
- Protecting the safety of customers, chefs, riders, and the platform

4.4 Platform Improvement and Analytics

- Analyzing usage patterns to improve platform features and performance
- Conducting research and development to enhance user experience
- Monitoring chef and vendor performance against platform standards
- Generating aggregated, anonymized insights about platform usage

4.5 Personalization

- Personalizing meal recommendations based on your preferences and order history
- Delivering targeted promotions and offers relevant to your usage

- Customizing your platform experience based on location and preferences

4.6 Marketing Communications

Where you have provided consent, we may use your contact information to send:

- Promotional offers, discounts, and seasonal campaigns
- Platform updates, new features, and service announcements
- Chef spotlights, food content, and community updates

You may opt out of marketing communications at any time by using the unsubscribe link in any email, adjusting your notification settings in the app, or contacting us directly. Opting out of marketing does not affect transactional communications related to active orders.

4.7 Legal and Regulatory Compliance

- Complying with applicable laws, regulations, and court orders
- Responding to lawful requests from government or regulatory authorities
- Maintaining records required by law for tax, financial, or audit purposes • Enforcing our Terms and Conditions and other platform policies

5. How We Share Your Information

eat4me does not sell your personal information to third parties. We share your information only in the circumstances described below and only to the extent necessary for the stated purpose.

5.1 Independent Chefs and Vendors

When you place an order, we share necessary information with the chef or vendor preparing your meal, including:

- Your name and order details
- Delivery address and contact number
- Dietary requirements and special instructions

Chefs and vendors are contractually required to use this information solely for fulfilling your order and are prohibited from using it for any other purpose, including unsolicited contact or marketing.

5.2 Independent Delivery Riders

To facilitate delivery, we share with delivery riders:

- Your delivery address and contact number
- Order collection details and pickup location

Riders access only the information necessary to complete the delivery and are prohibited from retaining or misusing customer data.

5.3 Payment Processors and Financial Partners

We share payment information with certified third-party payment processors to facilitate transactions and refunds. These partners are bound by strict data security and confidentiality obligations and may not use your information for any purpose other than processing your payment.

5.4 Technology and Service Providers

We engage third-party service providers to support platform operations, including:

- Cloud hosting and data storage providers
- Analytics and performance monitoring services
- Customer support technology platforms
- SMS and email communication services

All service providers are contractually bound to handle your information in accordance with this Privacy Policy and applicable data protection laws.

5.5 Regulatory and Government Authorities

We may disclose your personal information to government or regulatory authorities where required by law, court order, or regulatory process, or where we believe disclosure is necessary to protect the safety of any person or to prevent illegal activity.

5.6 Business Transfers

If eat4me is involved in a merger, acquisition, restructuring, or sale of assets, your personal information may be transferred to the acquiring entity as part of that transaction. We will notify you of any such transfer and the applicable privacy protections before your information is transferred and becomes subject to a different privacy policy.

5.7 With Your Consent

We may share your information with third parties for purposes not described in this Policy where we have obtained your explicit prior consent.

6. Data Retention

6.1 General Retention Principles

We retain your personal information only for as long as necessary to fulfill the purposes for which it was collected, comply with our legal obligations, resolve disputes, and enforce our agreements. When personal information is no longer needed, we securely delete or anonymize it.

6.2 Specific Retention Periods

- Account information: Retained for the duration of your account and for up to five (5) years following account closure, to comply with legal and tax obligations.
- Transaction and order records: Retained for a minimum of five (5) years in compliance with Ghanaian tax and financial record-keeping requirements.
- Payment records: Retained for the period required by applicable financial regulations, typically five (5) to seven (7) years.
- Customer support and dispute records: Retained for three (3) years following resolution of the relevant matter.
- Marketing communication records: Retained for the duration of your consent or until you withdraw consent, plus a reasonable period thereafter for compliance purposes.
- Chef and vendor verification documents: Retained for the duration of the chef's active status and for five (5) years following account closure.

6.3 User-Generated Content

Reviews, ratings, and feedback submitted through the platform may remain visible on the platform after account closure unless removal is specifically requested and granted. We reserve the right to retain anonymized review content for platform integrity purposes.

6.4 Legal Hold

Where personal information is subject to an ongoing legal dispute, regulatory investigation, or court order, we may be required to retain it beyond the periods described above until the matter is fully resolved.

7. Cookies and Tracking Technologies

7.1 What Are Cookies

Cookies are small text files placed on your device when you visit our website or use our app. They help us recognize you, remember your preferences, and improve your experience on the platform.

7.2 Types of Cookies We Use

- **Essential Cookies:** Required for the platform to function. These cannot be disabled as they are necessary for core features such as login, order processing, and payment security.
- **Performance Cookies:** Collect anonymized information about how users interact with the platform to help us improve functionality and performance.
- **Functional Cookies:** Remember your preferences such as language, location, and saved addresses to personalize your experience.
- **Marketing Cookies:** Used to deliver relevant promotions and track the effectiveness of our marketing campaigns. These are only placed with your consent.

7.3 Managing Cookies

You may manage or disable non-essential cookies through your browser or device settings at any time. Please note that disabling certain cookies may limit the functionality of some platform features. Our app may provide additional cookie preference controls within the settings menu.

7.4 Third-Party Tracking

We may use third-party analytics tools such as Google Analytics or similar services. These tools may collect usage data subject to their own privacy policies. We do not control third-party tracking technologies and encourage you to review their policies independently.

1. Data Security

- Encryption of sensitive data in transit and at rest
- Secure server infrastructure with access controls
- Regular security assessments and vulnerability testing
- Restricted internal access to personal data on a need-to-know basis
- Staff training on data protection and privacy obligations

8.2 Limitations of Security

No digital system or method of data transmission is completely secure. While we strive to protect your personal information using commercially reasonable standards, we cannot guarantee absolute security. You acknowledge that some risk of unauthorized access or data exposure exists and that you provide your personal information at your own risk.

8.3 Data Breach Notification

In the event of a personal data breach that is likely to result in a risk to your rights and freedoms, eat4me will notify the relevant data protection authority and affected users in accordance with the requirements of Ghana's Data Protection Act, 2012 (Act 843) and any applicable regulations. We will provide notice as promptly as practicable and include information about the nature of the breach, the data affected, and the steps being taken to address it.

8.4 Your Role in Security

You are responsible for maintaining the confidentiality of your account credentials. You should not share your login details with anyone. If you believe your account has been compromised, please contact us immediately through the channels listed in Section 15.

9. Your Rights Under Ghana's Data Protection Act

1.1 Security Measures

eat4me implements reasonable and appropriate technical and organizational measures to protect your personal information against unauthorized access, loss, destruction, alteration, or disclosure. These measures include:

Under Ghana's Data Protection Act, 2012 (Act 843), you have the following rights regarding your personal information held by eat4me:

9.1 Right of Access

You have the right to request a copy of the personal information we hold about you, information about how it is being used, and who it has been shared with. We will respond to access requests within a reasonable timeframe and in accordance with applicable law.

9.2 Right to Rectification

You have the right to request correction of any personal information we hold that is inaccurate, incomplete, or outdated. You may also update certain information directly through your account settings.

9.3 Right to Erasure

You have the right to request deletion of your personal information where it is no longer necessary for the purposes for which it was collected, where you have withdrawn consent, or where processing is unlawful. We will honor deletion requests subject to our legal obligations to retain certain records.

9.4 Right to Restrict Processing

You have the right to request that we restrict the processing of your personal information in certain circumstances, such as where you contest its accuracy or where processing is unlawful but you prefer restriction over deletion.

9.5 Right to Data Portability

Where processing is based on your consent or a contract, you have the right to receive your personal information in a structured, commonly used, and machine-readable format and to have it transmitted to another data controller where technically feasible.

9.6 Right to Object

You have the right to object to the processing of your personal information where processing is based on legitimate interests, including profiling. You also have an absolute right to object to processing for direct marketing purposes at any time.

9.7 Right to Withdraw Consent

Where we process your personal information based on your consent, you have the right to withdraw that consent at any time. Withdrawal of consent does not affect the lawfulness of processing carried out before withdrawal.

9.8 Right to Lodge a Complaint

You have the right to lodge a complaint with the Data Protection Commission of Ghana if you believe your personal information has been handled in a manner that violates the Data Protection Act, 2012. Contact details for the Data Protection Commission can be found at www.dataprotection.org.gh.

9.9 Exercising Your Rights

To exercise any of the rights described in this Section, please contact us using the details provided in Section 15. We may require you to verify your identity before processing your request. We will respond to all legitimate requests within thirty (30) days of receipt. In complex cases we may extend this period by a further thirty (30) days and will notify you accordingly.

10. Children's Privacy

The eat4me platform is intended for users aged eighteen (18) years and above. We do not knowingly collect, process, or store personal information from individuals under the age of eighteen (18).

If we become aware that we have inadvertently collected personal information from a minor, we will take immediate steps to delete that information from our systems and terminate the associated account. If you believe a minor has provided personal information to eat4me, please contact us immediately using the details in Section 15.

11. International Data Transfers

eat4me operates primarily within Ghana and processes most data within Ghana. Where we engage third-party service providers located outside Ghana — such as cloud infrastructure

providers or analytics platforms — your personal information may be transferred to and processed in countries with different data protection laws.

Where such transfers occur, we take steps to ensure that your personal information receives an adequate level of protection, including entering into appropriate data transfer agreements with recipients and ensuring compliance with applicable data protection standards.

By using the eat4me platform, you acknowledge that your information may be processed outside Ghana in accordance with this Privacy Policy.

12. Third-Party Links and Services

The eat4me platform may contain links to third-party websites, services, or applications that are not operated by eat4me. If you click on a third-party link, you will be directed to that third party's site or service. We strongly advise you to review the privacy policy of every third-party service you access.

eat4me has no control over and assumes no responsibility for the content, privacy practices, or data handling of any third-party websites or services. Your interactions with third-party services are governed by their own terms and privacy policies.

13. Automated Decision-Making and Profiling

eat4me may use automated processes to make certain decisions that affect your experience on the platform, including:

- Matching customers with nearby available chefs and cooks based on location and preferences;
- Generating personalized meal recommendations based on order history and dietary preferences;
- Monitoring chef and vendor performance scores based on customer ratings and fulfilment data;
- Detecting and flagging potentially fraudulent transactions or suspicious account activity.

Where automated decisions have a significant effect on you — such as account suspension based on fraud detection — you have the right to request human review of that decision. Please contact us using the details in Section 15 to exercise this right.

We do not make solely automated decisions with legally significant consequences without providing an opportunity for human review where required by applicable law.

2. Changes to This Privacy Policy

14.2 Notification of Changes

Where we make material changes to this Privacy Policy that affect your rights or how we use your personal information, we will notify you through:

- Email notification to your registered email address;
- In-app notifications;
- A prominent notice on the eat4me website or mobile application.

We will provide reasonable advance notice of material changes where practicable.

14.3 Continued Use as Acceptance

Your continued use of the eat4me platform after the effective date of any updated Privacy Policy constitutes your acceptance of the revised Policy. If you do not agree with any changes, you must discontinue use of the platform and may request account deletion in accordance with Section 9.3.

14.4 Version History

We maintain a record of previous versions of this Privacy Policy. If you wish to review a prior version, please contact us using the details in Section 15.

15. Contact Us & Data Protection Officer

2.1 Our Right to Update

eat4me reserves the right to update, modify, or revise this Privacy Policy at any time to reflect changes in our data practices, platform operations, applicable laws, or regulatory requirements.

If you have any questions, concerns, or requests regarding this Privacy Policy or the handling of your personal information, please contact eat4me using the following details:

eat4me Platform — Data Protection Email:

privacy@eat4me.app

Support Email: support@eat4me.org

Website: www.eat4me.org

Phone: 0541809756

Address: Twum Abeka Street, GI-392-60-69, Accra, Ghana

We aim to respond to all privacy-related inquiries within thirty (30) days of receipt. For urgent data security matters, please mark your communication as urgent and we will prioritize your request.

If you are not satisfied with our response, you have the right to lodge a complaint with the Data Protection Commission of Ghana:

Data Protection Commission of Ghana

Website: www.dataprotection.org.gh

Quick Reference Summary

For your convenience, here is a plain-language summary of the key points of this Privacy Policy:

- We collect personal information you provide when registering, ordering, or using the platform, plus technical data automatically collected during use.
- We use your information to process orders, facilitate delivery, process payments, prevent fraud, improve the platform, and communicate with you.
- We do not sell your personal information to third parties for marketing purposes.

- We share your information only with chefs, riders, payment processors, and service providers who need it to fulfil your order or support platform operations — all bound by confidentiality obligations.
- Your payment card and bank details are handled by certified third-party payment processors. We do not store complete payment credentials on our servers.
- You have the right to access, correct, delete, or restrict the processing of your personal information at any time.
- You can withdraw marketing consent and manage cookie preferences at any time.
- We retain your data only for as long as necessary and as required by law.
- If you have concerns, contact us at privacy@eat4me.app or the Data Protection Commission of Ghana.

This Privacy Policy was last updated and is effective as of the date of account registration or first platform access.

eat4me • Real Food. Real People. Near You.